Kansas City Rioting Ends With 6 Dead

Violence Subsides; 50 Injured

With a toll of 6 dead, more than 50 injured, over 500 arrested and 200 buildings burned, racial violence in Kansas City was brought to an end Thursday and by Sunday order had been restored sufficiently that 2,500 of the 3,500 National Guardsman rushed here last week were sent home. It was the first full-scale rioting in Kansas City in the history of the city.

Curfews, put into effect Tuesday night, April 9, after the first of two nightly outbreaks, were lifted Sunday. The worst violence came Wednesday night, April 10, when five persons were killed in a gun battle between police and snipers. All of them were Negro males. One man was killed on Tuesday night. Mayor Ilus Davis, Police Chief Clarence M. Kelley and Police Commissioner Joseph J. Kelley Jr., in a joint statement Sunday said "a careful survey of the events of the past 24 hours indicates that order has been restored in Kansas City."

Lt. Col. Eric Durham, public information officer for the National Guard, said troops were being released "as soon as they're packed and ready to go."

The joint statement also said that about one-half of the state patrolmen on duty throughout the city would return to their regular duties.

In a joint statement, the three officials said "the number of arrests and incidents of criminal nature are below average and it appears that tensions have been sharply reduced.

"Accordingly, at a conference between the law enforcement authorities and the city officials, the leadership of the National Guard and members of the police board, and in discussion with the governor, it was decided that there should be no curfew Sunday night and that there should be a reduction of National Guard and state patrol forces stationed in Kansas City effective as soon as it can be effected."

The officials said that one battalion of military police and about 100 state troopers will remain in the city.

Earlier in the day, Mayor Davis had lifted the ban on gasoline sales, stating that "it shall be permissible hereafter to sell, distribute and dispense gasoline and other inflammable and combustible products in lawful metal containers and regular gas tanks properly and securely affixed to motored vehicles."

Left in effect, however, was the ban on all sales of firearms, ammunition and weapons of any kind.

Depending calm enveloped this riot-scarred city through the daylight hours Saturday and brought partial relaxation of the rigid controls under which its people had lived during three days and

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nights of looting, burning, and sniper fire

The nightly curfew was set back four hours, Saturday permitting people to remain on the streets until 11 p.m. But after a meeting assessing the situation officials retained an around-the-clock ban on sale of guns, ammunition and gasoline in closed containers, and ordered taverns, bars and liquor stores to close at 7 p.m.

More than 3,000 national guardsmen and law officers remained in the city. Mayor Ilus W. Davis announced, after a telephone conference with Gov. Warren E. Hearnes, that the militia, comprising some 2,000 men, would remain at full strength through Saturday night.

Near the end of Saturday, a police dispatcher reported "it's been a great day, almost normal." For approximately 12 hours, he said, there had been no report of racial trouble that "came to anything."

In the preceding 24 hours, police had reported 17 confirmed cases of sniping and arrested four suspected snipers. A total of nearly 200 persons were arrested, mostly for curfew violations, bringing the total arrested from the outbreak of violence on Tuesday morning to midnight Friday to nearly 750.

For the second straight night, virtually no looting was reported Friday. There were eight small fires, including some set by arsonists, but all were quickly extinguished.

Only a few incidents were reported Saturday, one resulting in the arrest of three white men suspected of sniping near 12th and troost. Three other men were being sought in this case.

The three men arrested Saturday were booked into city jail on charges of carrying concealed weapons. They were expected to be arraigned Monday.

The three were identified as Roy D. Carrier, 46, of Shawnee, Kas., and Jackie Lyn Kirby, 23, and Turner Ray Woods, 39, both of Kansas City, Mo.

Police said they found two .22 caliber rifles and a .410 gauge shotgun in the building in which the men were arrested. The shotgun contained a spent .410 cartridge, and five live rounds of .410 ammunition were found on the roof of the building.

Popular members of the Chiefs football team, ministers of all denominations and organizational heads issued a call for an end to the full-scale rioting which broke out here Tuesday night and was repeated on an even larger scale Wednesday night.

White Snipers Nabbed

Two white men were arrested Thursday at 3015 Tracy on charges of sniping. They were firing from a third floor at firemen and policemen.

The two arrested for sniping are Wesley Allen Cox, 24, 3519 Tracy, and Leo Samuel Costanza, 129 Olive. Both were arrested at the Tracy Ave. address on charges of assault with intent to kill, felonious assault, carrying concealed weapons and possession of narcotics.

Police officers said that each man had a revolver and a high-powered rifle.

A police officer, Marion Bowman, with 15 years of service, died of a heart attack last night while helping a National Guardsman handle a mental patient at 3536 Main St.

A third white man was arrested at 36th and Locust on a charge of possession of firearms and marijuana.

Bonds for those arrested range from $25,000 to $100,000. Preliminary hearings have been set for April 16.

Bonds of $50,000 were set for those charged with burglary, stealing, breaking into stores and charges involving more than $50 in looting.

Bonds of $100,000 were set for those charged with possession of firebombs.

Firebomb Vacant House

A firebomb was thrown into a vacant house last night at 2511 Walrond. Fire was limited to the basement area and was extinguished by firemen who were protected from possible snipers by police and National Guardsmen.

Mayor Davis proclaimed a 7 p.m. to 6 a.m. curfew at mid-day Thursday following the worst night of rioting in Kansas City's history. It was the third straight night of living under curfew with all persons ordered to remain inside except to go to and from work.

All liquor stores, filling stations and taverns were ordered closed at 5 p.m.

The mayor's proclamation also banned the sale of firearms, ammunition and gasoline in containers.

Rioting broke out here Tuesday night just two days after 15,000 Kansas Citians, white and Negro, had held a peaceful march and memorial program in tribute to Dr. Martin Luther King Sunday afternoon on the Liberty Memorial mall.

The National Guard was called out Tuesday night to assist Kansas City police and a city-wide curfew was put into effect from 8 p.m. to 6 a.m.

Early Wednesday, Mayor Ilus W. Davis lifted the curfew Wednesday because the situation seemed to be improving, but about 7 o'clock Wednesday night rioting began anew on Prospect Ave. from 29th to about 37th St. and at 31st and Indiana. A second curfew was hastily put into effect at 9 p.m.

On Thursday (last night) the curfew began at 7 p.m. and was to last until 6 a.m. Friday. Only persons going to and from work were permitted on the streets.

Rioting in Kansas City came as a disappointment to both Negro and white citizens, as well as city officials and civil rights leaders, who had hoped that they had begun to reach the causes which have brought about violence in other cities. Until Tuesday night, Kansas City had escaped the rioting which has plagued hundreds of cities during the last few summers.

Started By Tear-Gas

The rioting Tuesday was touched off by incidents involving high school students. Civil rights leaders said frequently this week that members of the police department themselves triggered the rioting by the unwise and indiscriminate use of tear-gas on a group of Central, Lincoln and Manual students who were conducting a peaceful march from their schools to the City Hall in tribute to Dr. Martin Luther King, slain civil rights leader, whose funeral was being held Tuesday in Atlanta, Ga.

(Details on the tear-gassing will be found elsewhere on this page.)

Alvin Brooks, former chairman of Kansas City CORE, and John Wesson, newly-elected CORE chairman, said Wednesday that they feel that if the Board of Education had closed public schools Tuesday as a tribute to Dr. King, the school incident would not have occurred.

Wesson said that he sent a telegram to Mayor Ilus W. Davis asking that schools be closed but that he received no answer and no consideration. (Also Herman Johnson)

Members of the Board of Education and administrative officers said that they felt it better to keep schools open to keep students occupied and off the streets. Five Negro schools were closed Wednesday, however, after a second tear-gassing incident at Lincoln high school in which police officers were accused by H. I. Harwell, principal, several teachers and parents of using extremely poor judgement.

It was learned that several Negro administrators in the central school office suggested the closing of school Tuesday as a precautionary measure but they were overruled. Some students on the Missouri side became angry when they learned that students in Kansas City, Kas., had a holiday in memory of Martin Luther King. Lack of coordination between the two school systems was blamed by some persons as a cause of the trouble Tuesday. Wednesday's trouble which led to the widespread disorder Wednesday night stemmed from the activity during the day of police officers and National Guardsmen, called in Tuesday night, who harrassed adults and children in various parts of the Negro community throughout the day.

Incensed By Police Cars

The presence of police cars in an area incensed residents of neighborhoods in which there was no disturbance.

The arrest of five young men on Woodland between 10th and 11th street Wednesday afternoon was a case in point.

The five were seated in a car talking among themselves and to a friend standing on the outside when police officers arrested them for "disorderly conduct." They said that they were not committing any offense. When they were taken to police headquarters, young people in the area of the Wayne Miner project congregated on the corner of 10th and Woodland. Police cars passed by frequently "for no reason at all," people in the area said.

A woman who lives across the street from where the five were arrested said that she could testify that the youths were doing nothing when the police approached them

Meet With Youth

Between 200 and 300 young people, both of high school age and older out-of-school youth, met with civil rights leaders Wednesday afternoon at the Municipal Stadium to air their grievances in an effort to prevent further disorders. The stadium was opened by city officials at the request of the young people.

The discussions between adult and youth leaders continued Wednesday night at Tony's Walnut room at 32nd and Indiana with Bruce Watkins, circuit clerk, as the chairman. The discussions were in session as rioting broke out on Prospect Ave. between 31st and 37th Sts. and as fires were set at 31st and Indiana.

Governor Warren E. Hearnes, who cancelled his vacation to fly in from Jefferson City at the height of the riot Wednesday night, viewed the trouble area from a helicopter Thursday.

The governor flew into the city as yellow and black smoke belched skyward. Most fires were set in a three-block area of apartment houses and small shops.

Firemen fought one blaze on 31st street between Agnes and Benton late into the morning.

"We weren't able to get in here and put his fire out until this morning because of the snipers last night," a fireman said. "The shots came from up there," he said, pointing to a rooftop of a three-story apartment building.

"It looks like it was pretty well planned. Every place we had a major blaze there was a lousy sniper.'

A group of five young Negroes roamed nearby, one sipping from a liquor bottle.

The mayor issued a state of emergency Wednesday night, but not until four persons had been killed and numerous fires raged out of control. He had complied with pleas from Negro leaders earlier Wednesday not to declare a curfew.

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